

Verdant Peak Technologies - HR Handbook

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1. Welcome to Verdant Peak Technologies

This HR Handbook is designed to be the central reference guide for every employee at Verdant Peak Technologies (VPT), a global technology company specializing in cloud infrastructure and enterprise SaaS solutions, headquartered in Austin, Texas, with major offices in Bengaluru, India, and Krakow, Poland. Founded in 2011, VPT has grown to over 4,200 employees worldwide. This handbook summarizes key people processes and points employees to the detailed policies (Employee Policies, Leave Policy, IT Policies, Travel Policy, Benefits Documentation, and Code of Conduct) that govern daily work life.

2. Onboarding

New hires begin with a structured 2-week onboarding program managed by the People Operations team. Day 1 includes laptop provisioning, systems access setup, and an orientation session covering company history, mission, and values. Week 1 includes mandatory compliance training modules: Information Security Awareness, Anti-Harassment and Workplace Respect, and Code of Conduct certification, all of which must be completed within the first 10 working days. Each new employee is assigned a “Buddy” from their team for the first 30 days to help them navigate internal tools and culture. Managers are required to complete a 30-60-90 day onboarding plan for every new hire, with formal check-ins at each milestone.

3. Organizational Structure

VPT is organized into five primary business units: Engineering, Product, Sales & Customer Success, Marketing, and Corporate Functions (Finance, HR, Legal, IT). Each business unit is led by a Senior Vice President reporting to the Chief Executive Officer. Job levels range from L1 (Associate) through L10 (Executive Vice President), with corresponding career tracks for both individual contributors and people managers. The full organizational chart is maintained on the internal People Directory tool and updated weekly by HR Operations.

4. Career Development and Internal Mobility

VPT encourages internal mobility as a primary path for career growth. Employees who have been in their current role for at least 12 months (9 months for high performers with manager endorsement) may apply for internal job postings through the Internal Careers Portal. VPT also offers a Learning & Development stipend of \$1,500 (or local currency equivalent) per employee per year for external courses, certifications, and conferences, subject to manager approval and relevance to the employee's role. A structured Mentorship Program pairs employees with senior leaders twice per year, in March and September enrollment windows.

5. Compensation Philosophy

VPT benchmarks compensation against the 65th percentile of the relevant local technology market, reviewed annually by the Total Rewards team using third-party market data. Compensation consists of base salary, an annual performance bonus (target 10–20% of base salary depending on level), and for L5 and above, an equity award under the Restricted Stock Unit (RSU) Plan vesting over 4 years with a 1-year cliff. Compensation details are strictly confidential and discussing another employee's pay without their consent is discouraged, though employees retain the right to discuss their own compensation under applicable law.

6. Employee Relations and Grievance Handling

Employees experiencing workplace concerns are encouraged to first raise the matter with their direct manager. If the matter is not resolved, or is inappropriate to raise with the manager, employees may escalate to their HR Business Partner or submit a formal grievance through the Employee Relations Case Management system. All grievances are acknowledged within 2 working days and investigated within 15 working days, with the employee kept informed of progress throughout. VPT also operates an independent, third-party Ethics Hotline (available 24/7, multilingual) for anonymous reporting of concerns including harassment, fraud, or Code of Conduct violations.

7. Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

VPT is committed to building a workforce that reflects the diversity of the communities in which it operates. The Company maintains Employee Resource Groups (ERGs) including Women@VPT, Pride@VPT, VPT Veterans Network, and Global Multicultural Alliance, each with a modest annual budget for events and initiatives. Hiring panels for roles at L4 and above must include at least one member from a different function or background than the hiring manager, to reduce bias in the interview process. DEI metrics are reported to the Executive Leadership Team quarterly and summarized in the Company's Annual Impact Report.

8. Health, Safety, and Wellbeing

VPT provides an Employee Assistance Program (EAP) offering confidential counseling (up to 6 sessions per issue per year, free of charge) for employees and their immediate family members, covering

mental health, financial planning, and legal consultation topics. All office locations maintain a Health & Safety Committee that conducts quarterly workplace inspections and fire drills. Employees must report any workplace injury to their manager and the Facilities team within 24 hours using the Incident Report Form.

9. Recognition Programs

VPT operates a peer-to-peer recognition platform called “Peak Points,” where employees can award points to colleagues for embodying company values; points can be redeemed for gift cards, merchandise, or donated to charity. The Company also runs a quarterly “Summit Award” recognizing outstanding individual and team contributions, with winners announced at the All-Hands meeting and receiving a \$500 bonus.

10. Internal Communication

The primary channels for internal communication are the HR Portal (policy documents, forms, announcements), the monthly CEO Newsletter, the bi-weekly All-Hands meeting (recorded for asynchronous viewing), and the internal collaboration platform “Peak Connect” for team-level updates. HR conducts an annual Employee Engagement Survey each October, with results shared company-wide and action plans developed by each department by year-end.

11. Exit Process and Alumni Network

Departing employees complete a confidential exit interview with HR, covering reasons for departure and feedback on their experience. VPT maintains an Alumni Network that former employees may join to stay connected, receive company news, and be considered for “boomerang” rehire opportunities, which are actively encouraged for employees who left in good standing.

12. Questions and Support

For any HR-related question not addressed in this handbook or the associated policy documents, employees should contact their HR Business Partner or submit a ticket through the “Ask HR” portal, which targets a response time of 2 working days for general queries and same-day response for urgent matters.